You use symbols to name the session storage strategy; the symbol is converted into a CamelCase class name.

session_store = :cookie_store
: This is the default session storage mechanism used by Rails, starting with version 2.0. This format represents objects in their marshaled form, which allows any serializable data to be stored in sessions but is limited to 4 KB total. This is the option we used in the Depot application.

session_store = :active_record_store
: You can use the activerecord-session_store gem[158] to store your session data in your application's database using ActiveRecordStore.

session_store = :drb_store
: DRb is a protocol that allows Ruby processes to share objects over a network connection. Using the DRbStore database manager, Rails stores session data on a DRb server (which you manage outside the web application). Multiple instances of your application, potentially running on distributed servers, can access the same DRb store. DRb uses Marshal to serialize objects.

session_store = :mem_cache_store
: memcached is a freely available, distributed object caching system maintained by Dormando.[159] memcached is more complex to use than the other alternatives and is probably interesting only if you're already using it for other reasons at your site.

session_store = :memory_store
: This option stores the session data locally in the application's memory. Because no serialization is involved, any object can be stored in an in-memory session. As we'll see in a minute, this generally isn't a good idea for Rails applications.